2022 Summary

I'm a designer who helps growing organisations build great in-house teams

James Cook
Design leadership and community

Design lead, analyst, and problem finder
15 years industry experience, 26 online

London, GBR.

Experience

Sabbatical
Career break & travel
2022

Design Operations lead;
User Experience practice lead
OVO Energy • Bristol, Edinburgh, Lisbon, London & Selkirk
2017-21

User Experience Design lead
Springer Nature • Berlin, London, Pune
2015-17

Experience Design senior consultant;
Experience Design consultant
ThoughtWorks • Glasgow, London, S'pore
2012-15

User Experience Designer
Loco2 (now RailEurope) • London
2011-12

User Experience Analyst
Isotrak • London
2008-10

Web Developer
Cambridge Assessment • Cambridge
2007-08

2006-12 Freelance
2006-07 Cyfle/Sequence Digital
2005-06 Avanti Media
2002-03 CTC Plus

Expertise

Agile and lean methods
Iterative design and development
Cross-functional collaboration
Developing UX capability within teams
Design operations and staffing
Building and supporting community
Progressive enhancement; web standards

Study

Design for Visual Communication PGC
University of the Arts London

Interactive Media Design PGD
Cyfle Interactive, Cardiff

Design for Interactive Media BA (Hons)
University of Wales, Cardiff

Multimedia Product Design HND
Cardiff School of Art & Design

Recognition

2019 OVO Values Heroes finalist
2016 GovInsider Innovation Awards
2013 Google Global Impact Awards
2006 NESTA Innovate to Educate

Strengths

Analytical thinking
Pragmatic problem-solving
Workshop design, facilitation
Guerrilla testing, research
Mapping journeys and flows
IA, interaction, interface
Accessibility and inclusion
Mobile-first responsive
Communicating design
Aligning teams for delivery
Rapid ideation and iteration
Stakeholder engagement
UX outreach and education
UX community and culture
UX practice roadmapping
UX skills mapping
UX recruitment
Design mentoring

Approach

Servant leadership
Strong opinions, lightly held
Five whys, Active listening
Activity-centred design
Sketchflows and cribsheets
Pencil, paper, post-its, walls
Miro, Keynote, spreadsheets
Figma, Sketch, Adobe

linkedin.com/in/hellojames
Selected work on request

desk@hellojames.co.uk